2027 EDITION · TIMES HIGHER EDUCATION DATA

TOP 50

Universities in the world, *and what each does best*

The official THE World University Rankings 2027 top 50, with where each university is and the fields it is best known for.

1
Oxford
United Kingdom

2
MIT
United States

=3
Princeton & Stanford
United States



25 North America · **14** Europe · **10** Asia · **1** Oceania

Shaz Moghaddam · London · shazmoghaddam.github.io

1–9 · 11–20 · 21–29 · 29–40 · 41–50 · Charts

SWIPE →

1–9

North America · Europe · Asia · Oceania

1	**University of Oxford** 🇬🇧 Oxford, United Kingdom BEST FOR Medicine, law, humanities and PPE	97.9 SCORE	
2	**Massachusetts Institute of Technology** 🇺🇸 Cambridge, MA, United States BEST FOR Engineering, computer science, physics and AI	97.8 SCORE	
=3	**Princeton University** 🇺🇸 Princeton, NJ, United States BEST FOR Mathematics, physics, economics and public policy	97.0 SCORE	
=3	**Stanford University** 🇺🇸 Stanford, CA, United States BEST FOR Computer science, engineering and entrepreneurship	97.0 SCORE	
5	**University of Cambridge** 🇬🇧 Cambridge, United Kingdom BEST FOR Natural sciences, mathematics, engineering and medicine	96.9 SCORE	
6	**Harvard University** 🇺🇸 Cambridge, MA, United States BEST FOR Law, medicine, business and public health	96.7 SCORE	
7	**California Institute of Technology** 🇺🇸 Pasadena, CA, United States BEST FOR Physics, astronomy and space science (runs NASA JPL)	96.5 SCORE	
8	**Imperial College London** 🇬🇧 London, United Kingdom BEST FOR Engineering, medicine, natural sciences and business	95.2 SCORE	
=9	**University of California, Berkeley** 🇺🇸 Berkeley, CA, United States BEST FOR Computer science, engineering, chemistry and economics	94.3 SCORE	
=9	**Yale University** 🇺🇸 New Haven, CT, United States BEST FOR Law, history, political science and the arts	94.3 SCORE	

Score = THE overall score out of 100 · "=" means tied

Best for = the fields each university is best known for

11–20

North America · Europe · Asia · Oceania

11 Tsinghua University

🇨🇳 Beijing, China

BEST FOR Engineering, computer science and architecture

93.9 SCORE

12 ETH Zurich

🇨🇭 Zurich, Switzerland

BEST FOR Engineering, physics, computer science and architecture

93.6 SCORE

13 Peking University

🇨🇳 Beijing, China

BEST FOR Sciences, medicine, economics and humanities

92.8 SCORE

14 University of Pennsylvania

🇺🇸 Philadelphia, PA, United States

BEST FOR Business (Wharton), medicine and nursing

91.5 SCORE

15 National University of Singapore

🇸🇬 Singapore

BEST FOR Engineering, computer science, medicine and law

91.1 SCORE

16 University of Chicago

🇺🇸 Chicago, IL, United States

BEST FOR Economics, physics, law and sociology

90.7 SCORE

=17 Johns Hopkins University

🇺🇸 Baltimore, MD, United States

BEST FOR Medicine, public health and biomedical engineering

90.3 SCORE

=17 University College London

🇬🇧 London, United Kingdom

BEST FOR Medicine, neuroscience, architecture and education

90.3 SCORE

19 Columbia University

🇺🇸 New York, NY, United States

BEST FOR Journalism, law, business and international affairs

90.0 SCORE

20 University of California, Los Angeles

🇺🇸 Los Angeles, CA, United States

BEST FOR Medicine, psychology, film and engineering

89.9 SCORE

Score = THE overall score out of 100 · "=" means tied

Best for = the fields each university is best known for

21–29

North America · Europe · Asia · Oceania

21	**Cornell University** 🇺🇸 Ithaca, NY, United States BEST FOR Engineering, agriculture, hospitality and veterinary medicine	89.5	SCORE
22	**University of Toronto** 🇨🇦 Toronto, Canada BEST FOR Medicine, AI research, engineering and life sciences	89.1	SCORE
23	**University of Michigan** 🇺🇸 Ann Arbor, MI, United States BEST FOR Engineering, business, medicine and public policy	87.1	SCORE
24	**Carnegie Mellon University** 🇺🇸 Pittsburgh, PA, United States BEST FOR Computer science, AI, robotics and drama	85.9	SCORE
25	**Technical University of Munich** 🇩🇪 Munich, Germany BEST FOR Engineering, computer science and natural sciences	85.1	SCORE
26	**University of Washington** 🇺🇸 Seattle, WA, United States BEST FOR Medicine, computer science and global health	84.6	SCORE
27	**The University of Tokyo** 🇯🇵 Tokyo, Japan BEST FOR Physics, engineering, law and medicine	84.3	SCORE
28	**Nanyang Technological University** 🇸🇬 Singapore BEST FOR Engineering, materials science and AI	84.0	SCORE
=29	**New York University** 🇺🇸 New York, NY, United States BEST FOR Business, law, film and the arts, mathematics	83.5	SCORE
=29	**Northwestern University** 🇺🇸 Evanston, IL, United States BEST FOR Journalism, business, engineering and law	83.5	SCORE

Score = THE overall score out of 100 · "=" means tied

Best for = the fields each university is best known for

29–40

North America · Europe · Asia · Oceania

=29	**University of Edinburgh** 🇬🇧 Edinburgh, United Kingdom BEST FOR Informatics and AI, medicine, vet science, linguistics	83.5 SCORE	
32	**Duke University** 🇺🇸 Durham, NC, United States BEST FOR Medicine, law, public policy and business	83.4 SCORE	
33	**University of Hong Kong** 🇭🇰 Hong Kong BEST FOR Medicine, law, dentistry and business	82.6 SCORE	
=34	**University of Melbourne** 🇦🇺 Melbourne, Australia BEST FOR Medicine, law, education and life sciences	80.9 SCORE	
=34	**Zhejiang University** 🇨🇳 Hangzhou, China BEST FOR Engineering, computer science and agriculture	80.9 SCORE	
36	**EPFL** 🇨🇭 Lausanne, Switzerland BEST FOR Engineering, computer science and life sciences	80.5 SCORE	
37	**University of California San Diego** 🇺🇸 San Diego, CA, United States BEST FOR Oceanography, biology, medicine and engineering	80.3 SCORE	
38	**Fudan University** 🇨🇳 Shanghai, China BEST FOR Medicine, economics, journalism and sciences	80.2 SCORE	
39	**Shanghai Jiao Tong University** 🇨🇳 Shanghai, China BEST FOR Engineering, medicine, naval architecture and business	80.0 SCORE	
40	**King's College London** 🇬🇧 London, United Kingdom BEST FOR Medicine, nursing, dentistry, law and war studies	79.3 SCORE	

Score = THE overall score out of 100 · "=" means tied

Best for = the fields each university is best known for

41–50

North America · Europe · Asia · Oceania

41	**LMU Munich** 🇩🇪 Munich, Germany BEST FOR Humanities, medicine, physics and life sciences	78.7 SCORE	
42	**Chinese University of Hong Kong** 🇭🇰 Hong Kong BEST FOR Medicine, business and Chinese studies	77.8 SCORE	
43	**McGill University** 🇨🇦 Montreal, Canada BEST FOR Medicine, law, neuroscience and music	77.7 SCORE	
44	**University of British Columbia** 🇨🇦 Vancouver, Canada BEST FOR Forestry, earth and environmental sciences, medicine	77.6 SCORE	
=45	**KU Leuven** 🇧🇪 Leuven, Belgium BEST FOR Engineering, medicine, philosophy and theology	77.5 SCORE	
=45	**Heidelberg University** 🇩🇪 Heidelberg, Germany BEST FOR Medicine, life sciences and physics	77.5 SCORE	
47	**London School of Economics** 🇬🇧 London, United Kingdom BEST FOR Economics, politics, finance and social sciences	77.3 SCORE	
48	**University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign** 🇺🇸 Urbana-Champaign, IL, United States BEST FOR Engineering, computer science and accounting	77.1 SCORE	
49	**Georgia Institute of Technology** 🇺🇸 Atlanta, GA, United States BEST FOR Engineering, computer science and industrial engineering	77.0 SCORE	
50	**Delft University of Technology** 🇳🇱 Delft, Netherlands BEST FOR Engineering, architecture and water management	76.5 SCORE	

Score = THE overall score out of 100 · "=" means tied

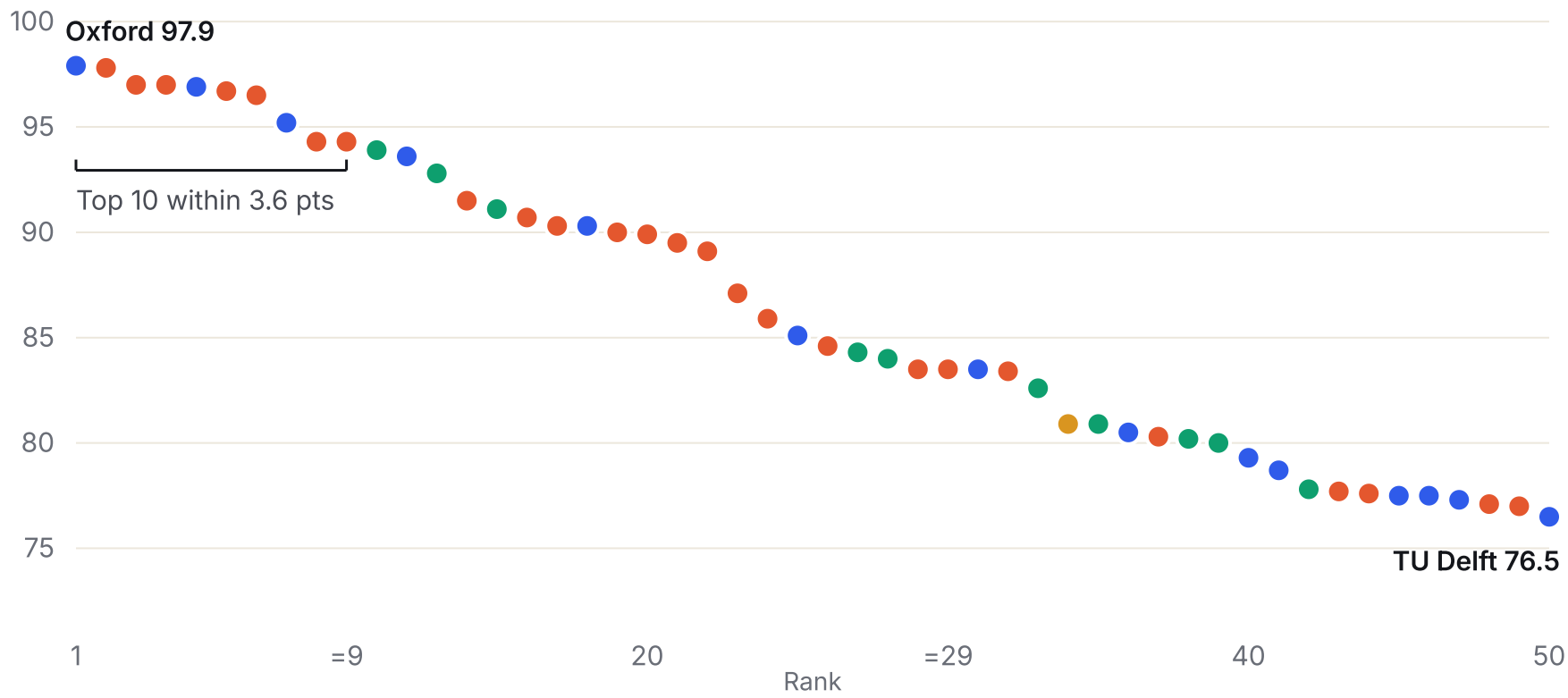
Best for = the fields each university is best known for

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The top 50 *in charts*

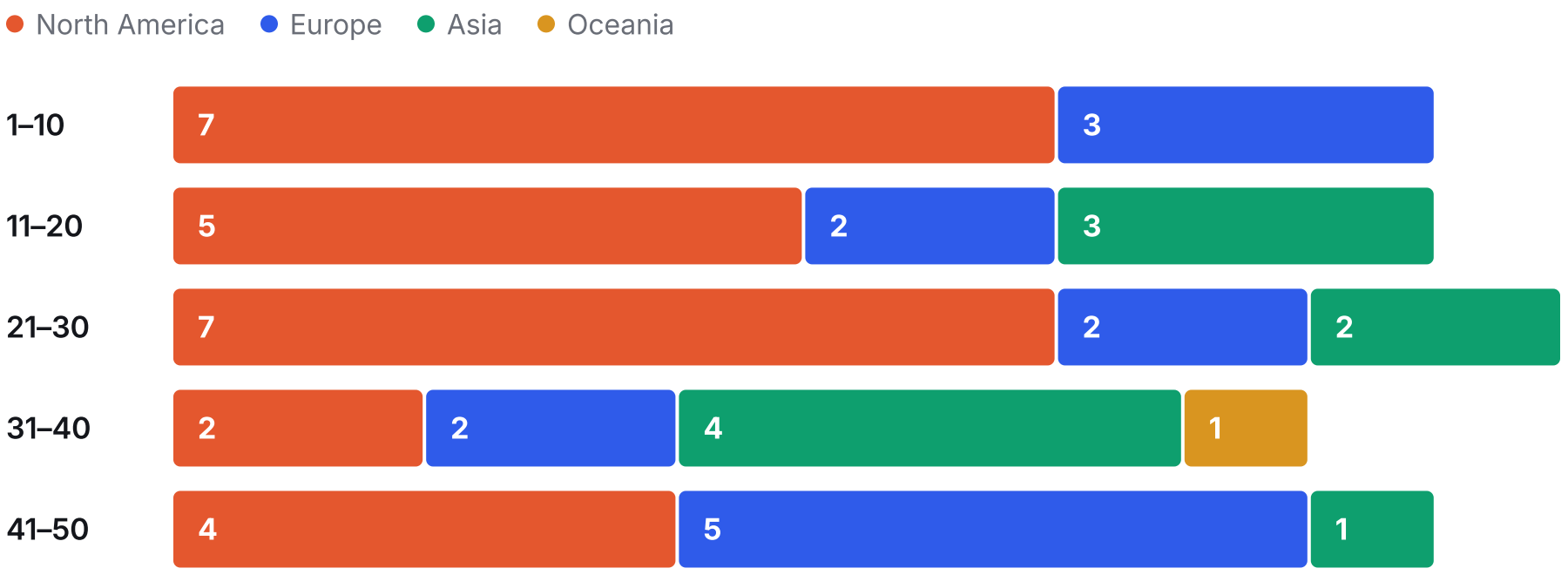
How close the scores are

Every top 50 university by overall score. Just 21.4 points separate 1st from 50th.



Who sits where in the ranking

Universities per region in each band of ten ranks (ties can push a band above ten). Asia's first entry is at 11.



Data: THE World University Rankings 2027

Colours show region

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What the 2027 list *tells us*

11 years

Oxford is number one for a record 11th year in a row, ahead of MIT by just 0.1 points.

22 of 50

The US has the most universities in the top 50, and the US and UK fill the whole top 10.

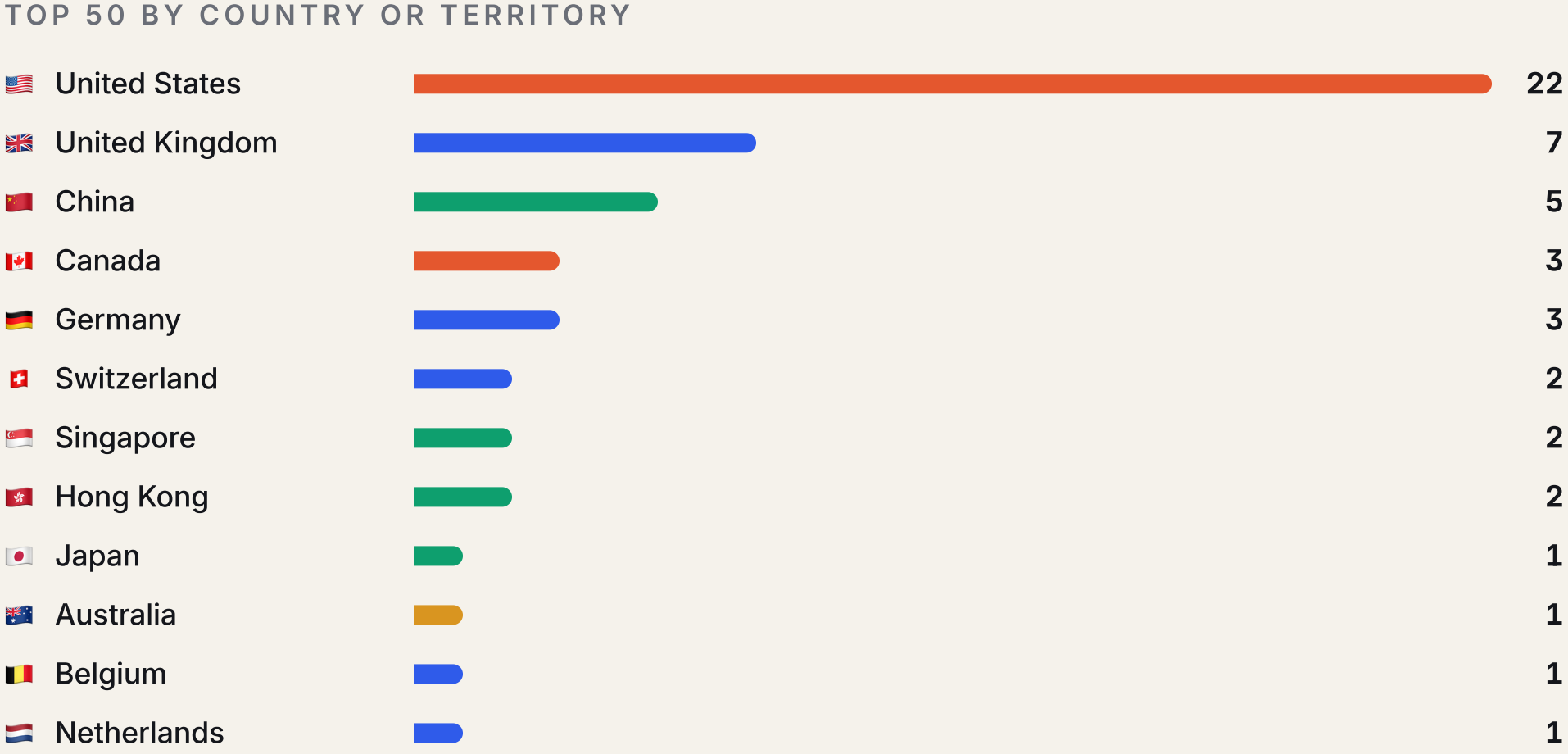
10 vs 7

Asian universities in the top 50 now outnumber those from continental Europe.

4 in London

Imperial, UCL, King's and LSE. LSE is back in the top 50 at 47th.

TOP 50 BY COUNTRY OR TERRITORY



Source: Times Higher Education World University Rankings 2027, published 30 September 2026. 2,297 universities ranked across 118 countries and territories, on teaching, research environment, research quality, industry and international outlook.

Best for is a short guide to each university's best known fields, not an official THE subject ranking.

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